# Beyond Machines & Mirrors

**From running clubs and padel to recovery and performance, fitness is finding new ground beyond the gym.**

**BY SHIVOHAAM**



Conversations on fitness naturally leading to the gym is par for the course. If you wanted to lose fat, build muscle, become stronger or simply "get into shape," you joined a gym. Fitness became associated with dumbbells, treadmills, mirrors, and workout regimes. And to be very clear, I still believe strength training is one of the most crucial activities for our body. Muscle, strength, and physical capacity become even more important as we age. Though there's something quite interesting happening around us...

The gym is no longer the only centre of the fitness universe. People are running. They are playing padel, pickleball, and tennis. They are training for HYROX. They are cycling, swimming, trekking, and golfing. Running clubs are becoming social communities. Sports clubs are becoming places where people meet, network, and spend their weekends.

Fitness is slowly moving beyond the idea of simply "working out" and becoming part of how people choose to live. It's turning into a lifestyle—an extremely positive shift as health was never meant to exist only inside a gym. The human body is designed for movement. We are meant to walk, run, lift, carry, throw, climb, rotate, jump, react, and play. Somewhere along the way, modern life removed most of this movement from our day and created a one-hour "exercise slot" to compensate for it.

We sit at home, sit in the car, sit at work, sit through meetings, sit while eating, and then go to the gym for 60 minutes, hoping that one hour will undo the remaining 23. Movement is much more than that.

This new fitness culture is interesting because people are not necessarily exercising to burn calories. They are moving because they enjoy the activity. And enjoyment changes everything.

When you play tennis with friends, go for a morning run with a community, train for a HYROX competition, or spend a few hours playing a sport, movement stops feeling like punishment. There is purpose, skill,

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